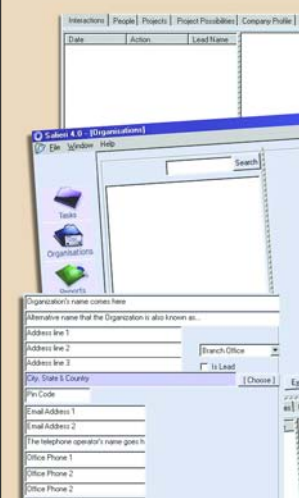


**S P S Grover**

Senior Director, Government
Education & Health, Oracle India

Oracle CRM leverages Oracle's single data model to provide organisations with a single version of 'truth' about their customers. It enables customers to move from fragmented, high-cost architectures, and improve the quality of their data. The CRM application is designed to help both marketing and sales aspects of an organisation by providing sales users at all levels through daily business intelligence, transaction reports and ad-hoc analyses. It is an application that can be implemented across different sectors—from banks, to telecom, to insurance. Training in CRM applications is not very difficult and helps them manage CRM optimally. However, unless there is someone at the top who can drive change across the company, and make decisions when departmental silos disagree, the technology will never be adopted.



MANAGE CLIENT

CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT (CRM) is a software solution that helps businesses manage customer relationships in an organised manner. By the end of 2002, market analysis firm IDC estimated the CRM market in India to be worth Rs 40 crore. Is CRM the ideal customer management solution? We present views from five industry experts who have deployed CRM in their domains



Argho Chatterjee
Inside Sales Specialist
Lionbridge Technology

We specialise in selling solutions. Unlike a product, a typical sales cycle for selling a solution would be between nine to 10 months. The CRM Module is used as an interaction tool between the sales people in the US and the support team in India. The number of companies approached, contacts made, and the whole sales loop can be tracked by a support person in India—with the help of CRM. It helps sales directors all over the world in accessing data anytime. The CRM module helps them in strategising, campaigns, and design the sales approach. In this way, the sales cycle is reduced to six to seven months. It subsequently translates to much higher profits for the company, and better utilisation of resources. The training required for the module varies on its complexity. A CRM module makes sales management more effective and shortens the sales cycle of a solution.